

PHARMACOVIGILANCE

Virtual Task Summary – Case Classification Sheet

Reference Video: “How to create a case classification sheet”

Topic: Case classification in Pharmacovigilance / ADR case processing

1. Introduction

Case classification is an important part of pharmacovigilance case processing. After an adverse event or suspected adverse drug reaction (ADR) is reported, the case is reviewed and classified using the available patient, event, medicine and reporter information. Proper classification helps maintain consistent safety records and supports further assessment of medicine safety.

2. Purpose of a Case Classification Sheet

- To organize important information from an individual safety case.
- To determine whether the report contains the minimum information required for processing.
- To classify the type and seriousness of the reported event.
- To support consistent case review, assessment and follow-up.
- To help identify cases that may require medical review, expedited handling or further investigation.

3. Important Information Reviewed

Section	Examples of information reviewed
Patient	Age, sex, relevant identifiers and other available patient details
Suspected event	Reaction/event description, onset, outcome and seriousness
Suspected medicine	Drug name, dose, route, indication and treatment dates
Other medicines	Concomitant medicines and relevant exposure information
Medical history	Relevant diseases, allergies, laboratory findings and history
Reporter	Reporter type and contact/follow-up information, when available

4. General Classification Process

1. **Receive the case:** Review the available report and supporting information.
2. **Check completeness:** Confirm that essential patient, event, medicine and reporter information is available.
3. **Identify the event:** Understand and document the reported adverse event/ADR.
4. **Assess seriousness:** Determine whether the case meets seriousness criteria such as death, life-threatening condition, hospitalization, disability or congenital anomaly.
5. **Review medicines and history:** Examine suspected and concomitant medicines and relevant medical information.
6. **Classify the case:** Apply the appropriate case categories according to the applicable pharmacovigilance procedure.

7. Follow up when needed: Seek additional information when the case requires clarification or assessment.

5. Importance in Pharmacovigilance

Accurate case classification improves the quality of individual case safety reports (ICSRs), supports signal detection and helps pharmacovigilance teams evaluate medicine-related risks. In India, the Pharmacovigilance Programme of India (PvPI) collects, collates and analyses drug-related adverse events to support patient safety and appropriate regulatory action.

6. Role of Healthcare Professionals

Healthcare professionals such as pharmacists, doctors and nurses contribute to pharmacovigilance by recognizing suspected ADRs, documenting relevant information, reporting cases and cooperating with follow-up activities. PvPI encourages reporting of suspected adverse reactions through its ADR reporting system.

7. Key Learning Points

- A case classification sheet provides a structured way to review a pharmacovigilance case.
- Good-quality patient, event, medicine and reporter information is essential.
- Seriousness and other case characteristics should be assessed systematically.
- Consistent classification supports reliable safety-data analysis.
- Case processing ultimately contributes to safer use of medicines and better patient care.

8. Conclusion

Case classification is a key step in pharmacovigilance case processing. A systematic classification approach helps ensure that safety reports are organized, assessed consistently and made useful for signal detection, risk evaluation and patient-safety activities.

Note: The YouTube page confirms the video title, but its full spoken transcript was not available through the accessible page. Therefore, this PDF is an assignment-ready summary of the video topic rather than a word-for-word transcript.

Reference: WHO Pharmacovigilance guidance; Indian Pharmacopoeia Commission – Pharmacovigilance Programme of India (PvPI).